

The Map for Tonight

Act One only · everyone seated · scripts and pencils · Six Characters · Village Players · dir. Kiarash Jamshidi

THE TWO MOVES, EACH PART

1 · The Italian way. Fast, flat, no emotion, no stopping — it drills the cues and lets us hear the shape.

2 · The action. For each line I call, say “**I ___ you**” — subject, verb, object. One verb per thought. Feeling comes out of doing.

ORDER OF THE EVENING

Warm up → then the six parts in order, each read the Italian way then actioned → a short break after The Veil → finish with a bit of practice.

Warm-up · 18:00

Ten to fifteen minutes, seated: voice and breath. Loosen the tongue for the fast reading to come. Then we begin, part by part.

Part by part

18:15 Part I — The Rehearsal

In it: The Manager, Player 1, Player 2, Player 3

- 1 Read it the Italian way.** The whole part, script in hand, as fast as you can — flat, no emotion, no pauses, cues snapped up the instant they land.
- 2 Action it — line by line.** For each line I point to, say what you are doing to the other person as *subject – verb – object*: “**I ___ you.**” One strong verb per thought, pencilled in. The Manager cracks the whip; the Players drag their feet. Model: Manager — “*I herd you.*” Player 1 — “*I upstage you.*”

Ask (one sentence, in character):

- The Manager** What kind of day are you having before they walk in? / What do you really think of the play you're forced to rehearse? / What would make tonight a good night for you?
 - Player 1** What do you think you're owed in this company? / What was the best role you ever played — and how long ago? / What are you afraid the others see when they look at you?
 - Player 2** What keeps you patient with all of them? / What do you do here that nobody thanks you for? / What would you rather be doing?
 - Player 3** What are you still excited about? / What do you want to learn from the older two? / What don't you understand about this job yet?
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18:30 Part II — The Arrival

In it: *The Father, The Step-Daughter, The Manager, the Players*

- 1 **Read it the Italian way.** The whole part, script in hand, as fast as you can — flat, no emotion, no pauses, cues snapped up the instant they land.
- 2 **Action it — line by line.** For each line I point to, say what you are doing to the other person as *subject – verb – object*: “**I ____ you.**” One strong verb per thought, pencilled in. The Father talks his way in; the Step-Daughter throws “Valentine” like a stone. Model: Father — “*I intrigue you*” → “*I dare you.*”

Ask (one sentence, in character):

- **The Father** What do you need them to believe? / Which story do you most want told — and why now?
 - **The Manager** When do you stop wanting to throw them out? / What first makes you curious instead of angry?
 - **The Step-Daughter** Why sing “Valentine” to a room of strangers?
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18:52 Part III — The Veil

In it: *The Mother, The Father, The Step-Daughter*

- 1 **Read it the Italian way.** The whole part, script in hand, as fast as you can — flat, no emotion, no pauses, cues snapped up the instant they land.
- 2 **Action it — line by line.** For each line I point to, say what you are doing to the other person as *subject – verb – object*: “**I ____ you.**” One strong verb per thought, pencilled in. He lifts the veil against her will; she names what he did. Model: Father — “*I display her.*” Step-Daughter — “*I expose you.*”

Ask (one sentence, in character):

- **The Mother** What are you trying to stop from happening? / Who are you most afraid for? / Why can't you speak the way the others do?
 - **The Step-Daughter** What do you want them to see that the Father won't say? / What has he done to you?
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19:25 Part IV — The Defence

In it: *The Father, The Mother, The Step-Daughter, The Manager*

- 1 **Read it the Italian way.** The whole part, script in hand, as fast as you can — flat, no emotion, no pauses, cues snapped up the instant they land.
- 2 **Action it — line by line.** For each line I point to, say what you are doing to the other person as *subject – verb – object*: “**I ____ you.**” One strong verb per thought, pencilled in. The big one. The Father's defence must be a fight, not a lecture. Model: Father — “*I explain*” → “*I plead*” → “*I attack.*”

Ask (one sentence, in character):

- **The Father** What are you ashamed of that you'll talk around? / When you look at the Step-Daughter, what do you feel?
 - **The Mother** What is the one sentence he can never talk you out of?
 - **The Step-Daughter** Why is being 'made pretty' worse than being ignored?
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20:00 Part V — The Hinge

In it: *The Son, The Father, The Step-Daughter*

- 1 **Read it the Italian way.** The whole part, script in hand, as fast as you can — flat, no emotion, no pauses, cues snapped up the instant they land.
- 2 **Action it — line by line.** For each line I point to, say what you are doing to the other person as *subject – verb – object*: “**I ____ you.**” One strong verb per thought, pencilled in. The Son shuts every door. Model: Son — “*I refuse you.*” Father — “*I corner you.*”

Ask (one sentence, in character):

- **The Son** Why don't you want to be here? / What were you promised as a child that you never got? / What would you do if you could just walk out?
 - **The Manager** What do you risk if you listen to them?
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20:15 Part VI — The Bargain

In it: *The Father, The Manager, The Step-Daughter*

- 1 **Read it the Italian way.** The whole part, script in hand, as fast as you can — flat, no emotion, no pauses, cues snapped up the instant they land.
- 2 **Action it — line by line.** For each line I point to, say what you are doing to the other person as *subject – verb – object*: “**I ____ you.**” One strong verb per thought, pencilled in. He sells the tragedy; the Manager buys. Model: Father — “*I tempt you.*” Manager — “*I give in.*”

Ask (one sentence, in character):

- **The Father** What are you offering him — and what are you hiding? / What can a stage give you that nothing else can? / What happens to you if he says no?
 - **The Manager** What finally makes you say yes? / What do you tell yourself to justify it? / What are you already imagining the audience will think?
 - **The Step-Daughter** What are you afraid they'll make pretty? / Which part of the story must they keep, no matter what? / What do you want out of being watched?
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A bit of practice • 20:35

To finish: pick one or two parts and run them once more — still seated — this time *playing the actions* we found, at a normal pace, cues tight. Not a performance; just a taste of the scene standing on its own feet, so everyone leaves with the act in the body. Then a go-round: one sentence each — “*In Act One, I am trying to ____.*”

Break after The Veil (about 19:10). We are reading to discover, not to perform — nothing is fixed tonight. The staging comes in August; tonight is the words, the cues, and the actions under them.